

Energy Coaching in MA

GIS for Urban & Regional Policy

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What is energy coaching?

Energy coaching is a practice where residents contact an organization, usually either a local non-profit or their municipality, for support on the performance of their current heating & cooling systems.

The “coaches” who speak with the residents are trained in answering questions and addressing concerns the residents may have.

Good coaches **do not pressure** the residents and instead simply advise on options and potential savings from the switch to heat pumps. It is not meant to be a sales pitch.

I’ve heard through my internship grapevine that coaching towns are generally more affluent, which is interesting because...



Digging into it...

Massachusetts has some of the most comprehensive programs and incentives available to low & middle income (LMI) households for clean heating, such as steep discounts, rebates, and 0% interest loans to help cover the costs of upgrades. **Sometimes, they even cover the entire project cost.**

It's important to explore whether towns with coaching are higher income because this would mean that coaching is not as available to the MA residents who would be eligible for the largest incentives.

Towns with coaching have seen notable increases in heat pump adoption, and there are many notable benefits which are relevant to LMI households.



Research Question

How do the median incomes (per capita) of MA municipalities with coaching programs differ from those without coaching programs?



Why is it important for LMI households?

Better for the planet

(which leads to)

Lower utility bills

(and has)

Increased comfort

(in addition to)

Even more benefits...

It's a matter of equity!

Analytic Strategy

Take data from 3 sources

- MassDOR Income per capita data
- MassGIS Municipal Boundaries
- Excel data on towns with coaching from my internship supervisor (Manager of Community Solutions at NEEP)

I took the income data and joined it to the excel sheet with the coaching towns, and changed the coaching to be Y or N.

Then, I took this sheet with the income and coaching data, and joined it to the MassGIS municipal boundaries in ArcGIS. This put all of the data in one place and allowed me to do things like select by attribute and export new files that were used for analysis of coaching vs no coaching independently.

**DLS**
DIVISION OF LOCAL SERVICES
MA DEPARTMENT OF REVENUE

Data Analytics and Resources Bureau
DOR Income and EQV Per Capita
Data current as of 12/03/2025

[Return to Last page](#)
For Questions or Assistance Email us at :
databank@dor.state.ma.us

Select Municipalities: Select Fiscal Year:

Data Legend based on Cherry Sheet FY

DOR Code	LEA Code	Municipality	County	Cherry Sheet FY	Population	DOR Income	DOR Income Per Capita	EQV	EQV Per Capita
001	1	Abington	PLYMOUTH	2026	16,970	762,508,000	44,933	3,278,516,900	193,195
002	2	Action	MIDDLESEX	2026	24,029	2,118,076,000	88,147	6,835,035,500	284,449
003	3	Acushnet	BRISTOL	2026	10,602	453,724,000	42,796	1,978,241,600	186,591
004	4	Adams	BERKSHIRE	2026	7,995	217,633,000	27,221	789,861,000	98,794
005	5	Agawam	HAMPDEN	2026	28,406	1,058,823,000	37,275	4,389,799,200	154,538
006	6	Alford	BERKSHIRE	2026	481	22,392,000	46,553	387,943,300	806,535
007	7	Amesbury	ESSEX	2026	17,303	807,867,000	46,689	3,931,853,000	227,235
008	8	Amherst	HAMPSHIRE	2026	40,277	682,908,000	21,921	3,668,642,000	91,085

Mass.gov

[Home](#) > [Executive Office of Technology Services and Security](#) > [MassGIS Home](#) > [MassGIS Data Layers](#)

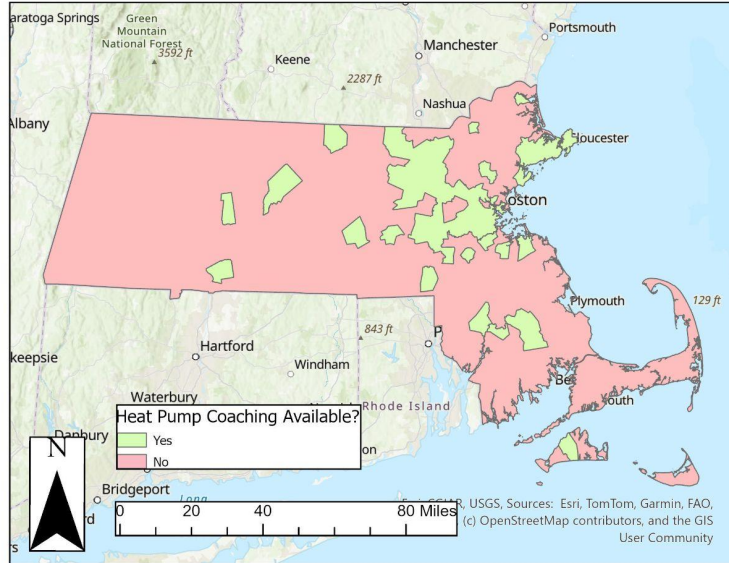
 OFFERED BY [MassGIS \(Bureau of Geographic Information\)](#)

MassGIS Data: Municipalities

May 2024

Background

Areas with & without Energy Coaching in MA



Population (w/ Coaching)

- 2,773,015 people
- 39.45% of MA Population
 - Boston alone has 675,647 people, or about a quarter of that 2.77 million people.
 - 9.6% of total MA population
- 62 municipalities

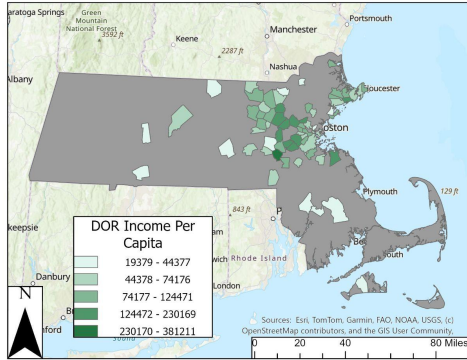
Population (w/ out Coaching)

- 4,256,902 people
- 60.55% of MA Population
- 289 municipalities

I calculated these population & municipality count data by using the summary statistics analytical tool.

I also dissolved all of the areas that have coaching and those that do not to avoid unnecessary crowding from every individual municipal boundary.

Munis with Energy Coaching in MA & Median Incomes per capita



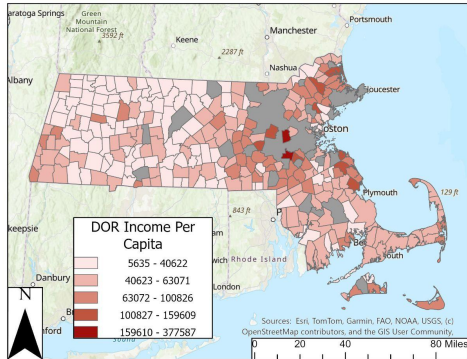
Munis **with** Coaching

Calculated the median income per capita
using the histogram tool

79,905

— Median: 79905

Munis without Energy Coaching in MA & Median Incomes per capita



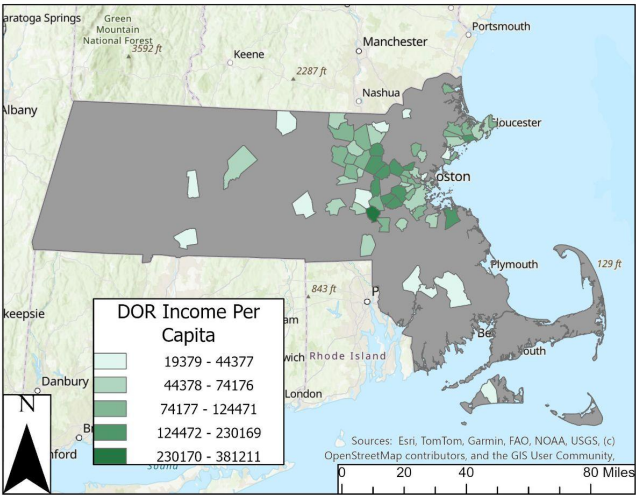
Munis **without** Coaching

Calculated the median income per capita
using the histogram tool

45,421

— Median: 45421

Munis with Energy Coaching in MA & Median Incomes per capita

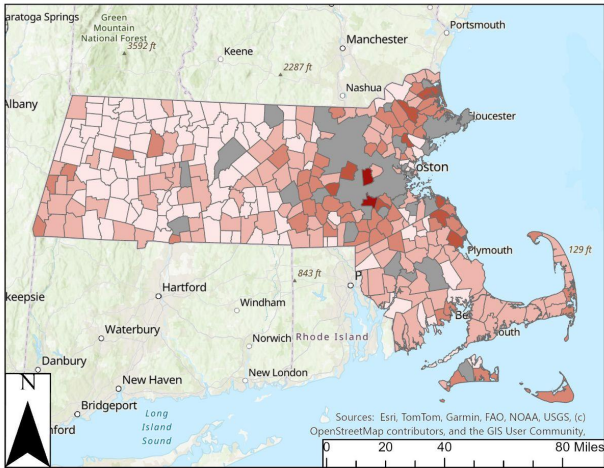


Distribution of Yes Coaching Incomes



Bin count: 40 | Bin size: 10,000

Munis with Energy Coaching in MA & Median Incomes per capita



Distribution of No Coaching Incomes



Bin count: 40 | Bin size: 10,000

Overall MA:

MEDIAN_DOR_Income_Per_Capita

47294

Conclusions

- Municipalities with coaching programs have much higher median incomes per capita than municipalities without coaching programs
- Therefore, I recommend that enhanced support from the state be given to these municipalities that do not have coaching programs and have the lowest incomes per capita.
 - Similar programs have been funded/supported by the state, such as the MEM grant program.